RFC-0002

Lore Specification

Version: Draft 0.1

Status: Experimental

Author: Searchlores Academy

Abstract

This document defines the Lore format.

A Lore is the native knowledge unit of Searchlores.

A Lore is not a prompt.

A Lore is not a document.

A Lore is not a dataset.

A Lore is a reusable investigation template.

Its purpose is to encode investigative knowledge about a domain.

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1. Design Goals

The Lore format MUST be:

- Human readable
- Machine readable
- Versionable
- Extensible
- Domain independent
- Investigation oriented

The Lore format MUST NOT:

- Encode answers

- Encode conclusions
- Encode dogma

The Lore format SHOULD:

- Encourage exploration
- Encourage contradiction discovery
- Encourage source tracing

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2. File Extension

Official extension:

```
.lore
```

Examples:

```
llm.lore

linux.lore

economics.lore

history.lore
```

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3. Serialization Format

Current canonical format:

```
YAML
```

Future formats MAY include:

```
JSON

TOML
```

```
XML
```

YAML remains the reference implementation.

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4. Mandatory Structure

Every Lore MUST contain:

```
version:

metadata:

domain:

investigation:
```

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5. Metadata Section

Purpose:

Describe the Lore itself.

Example:

```
metadata:

  name: LLM Investigation

  author: Searchlores Academy

  version: 1.0

  category: artificial_intelligence

  tags:

    - llm

    - ai
```

```
    - cognition
```

---

6. Domain Section

Purpose:

Define the domain under investigation.

Example:

```
domain:

  title: Large Language Models

  description: >
    Statistical language systems
    trained on large text corpora.
```

---

7. Investigation Section

Core section.

Contains all investigative structures.

Example:

```
investigation:

  assumptions:

  myths:

  contradictions:

  vectors:

  questions:

  narratives:
```

```
  sources:
```

---

8. Assumptions

Purpose:

List common hidden assumptions.

Example:

```
assumptions:

  - intelligence

  - understanding

  - reasoning

  - agency
```

Meaning:

The engine should challenge these concepts.

---

9. Myths

Purpose:

Record dominant narratives.

Example:

```
myths:

  - AI thinks

  - AI understands
```

```
  - AI is objective
```

The engine SHOULD generate:

- myth analysis
- counter questions
- source tracing

---

10. Contradictions

Purpose:

Record known tensions.

Example:

```
contradictions:

  - statement_a: AI understands

    statement_b: AI predicts tokens

  - statement_a: Open AI

    statement_b: Closed ecosystem
```

---

11. Search Vectors

Purpose:

Expand inquiry.

Example:

```
vectors:

  - economics

  - cognition
```

```
  - philosophy

  - labor

  - regulation
```

The engine SHOULD create exploration branches.

---

12. Questions

Purpose:

Provide seed questions.

Example:

```
questions:

  - Who benefits?

  - Who loses?

  - What assumptions exist?

  - What evidence is missing?
```

---

13. Narratives

Purpose:

Describe recurring stories.

Example:

```
narratives:

  - title: Techno-Optimism

    promises:
```

```
    - abundance

    - automation

  omissions:

    - dependency

    - concentration of power
```

---

14. Sources

Purpose:

Define preferred knowledge origins.

Example:

```
sources:

  primary:

    - arxiv

    - paperswithcode

    - benchmark repositories

  secondary:

    - books

    - surveys

  tertiary:

    - blogs

    - summaries
```

---

15. Deliverables

Purpose:

Specify expected outputs.

Example:

```
deliverables:

  - inquiry_report

  - contradiction_graph

  - source_tree

  - search_map
```

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16. Archaeology Section

Optional.

Provides reverse-engineering instructions.

Example:

```
archaeology:

  prompts:

    enabled: true

  narratives:

    enabled: true

  sources:

    enabled: true
```

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17. Plugin Hooks

Purpose:

Allow Lore-driven plugin execution.

Example:

```
plugins:

  - assumption_cracker

  - contradiction_hunter

  - mythology_scanner
```

The engine SHOULD load matching plugins automatically.

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18. Validation Rules

A valid Lore MUST:

- contain metadata
- contain a domain
- contain investigation

A Lore SHOULD:

- contain vectors

A Lore MAY:

- contain narratives
- contain archaeology
- contain plugins

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19. Example Complete Lore

```
version: 1.0
```

```yaml
metadata:

  name: LLM Investigation

  author: Searchlores Academy

domain:

  title: Large Language Models

investigation:

  assumptions:

    - intelligence

    - understanding

  myths:

    - AI thinks

  vectors:

    - cognition

    - economics

    - regulation

  questions:

    - Who benefits?

    - Who loses?

deliverables:

  - search_map

plugins:

  - assumption_cracker

  - contradiction_hunter
```


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20. Philosophy

A Lore is not a knowledge base.

A Lore is not a prompt template.

A Lore is not an encyclopedia.

A Lore is an investigation blueprint.

It describes where to search.

Not what to believe.